Christmas Cane Cookies (4 doz.)

375°

1C butter or reg. margarine
1C sifted confectioners sugar
1 egg
1½ t. vanilla
½ t. almond extract
2½ C sifted flour
½ t salt
½ t red food color
¼ C. crushed red & white peppermint candy
¼ C sugar

Beat butter & confectioners s. until mixture is light & fluffy. Beat in egg, vanilla & almond extract to blend well. Mix flour & salt & stir into creamed mixture. Divide in half. Blend food color into one half. Work with ¼ plain dough and ¼ tinted dough. Keep remainder of

dough in refrigerator until you are ready to use.

Take 1 tsp. plain dough and roll with hands into a strip 4" long. Then roll 1 tsp. tinted dough into a strip the same length. Lay the 2 strips side by side & twist together, holding both ends of strips. Place the ropes on ungreased baking sheets, curving one end. Make 1 cane at a time so the dough will not dry out. Place canes about 1" apart (12 to baking sheet).

Bake about 10 min. Remove from baking sheet at once. Combine candy & white sugar; sprinkle on hot cookies. Cool on racks.